

Project 1: Personal Home Page
Author: Milena Perez-Gerus
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Course: CS5610 - Web Development

Project Description

This project is a personal homepage for Milena Perez-Gerus, a Master's student in Data Science at Northeastern University. The site introduces who I am, shows the research and coursework I've done with satellite data, and shares my personal interests outside of work. Its main audiences are hiring managers, researchers, and professors I may work with.

The site has three pages. About (the homepage) has a short bio, links, experience, and education. Projects presents my research and coursework, each with dates, a description, tools used, reports and links to code, and a representative figure. Personal is a photo gallery where clicking a photo reveals a caption with the date and notes on the setting.

The design is minimalist and inspired by the layout of a book. The home page is a single left-aligned column of text in a serif font with soft colored background and intentional spacing. The goal is for visitors to find information immediately and simply. The design is inspired by minimal websites like minchi.co and the gallery at deadsimplesites.com. A live clock in the header displays the date and time in Boston to show the where I am based.

User Personas

Persona 1: Lila the Technical Recruiter

- **Background:** A recruiter for a satellite imaging software company. She reviews a multitude of candidates a week.
- **Goals:** Efficiently decide whether a candidate's skills and experience match the open role.
- **Pain Points:** Portfolio websites that are cluttered and too complicated to navigate quickly.
- **Behavior:** Spends only a couple minutes reviewing resumes and linked websites. Looks for experience, GitHub, and relevant projects.

Persona 2: Dr. G, the Research Principal Investigator

- **Background:** Leads a satellite data science lab and is looking for a new researcher.
- **Goals:** Understand the methods and motivation behind the candidate's work.
- **Pain points:** Projects listed with no details, reports, or evidence of the work done by the candidate.
- **Behavior:** Opens reports and papers, checks which methods and datasets were used.

Persona 3: Ed, the graduate classmate

- **Background:** data science student in the same program.

- **Goals:** Get to know a classmate before reaching out about mutual interests on an upcoming group project.
- **Pain points:** Website that does not show who a person is outside of their academic credentials.
- **Behavior:** Browses casually and clicks around to find shared personal interests and technical skills.

User stories

User Story 1: Lila checks a candidate during her time between HR meetings

As a recruiter, I want to see a candidate's experience and projects within a minute from my computer, so that I can quickly decide whether to set up a recruiter call with them.

Lila gets Milena's homepage link from an application and opens it. The layout is easy to digest with Milena's name and bio at the top. She scrolls to experience and sees the Esri internship and NASA DEVELOP role, which fit the background the company is looking for. She clicks the projects tab and sees the NASA DEVELOP project with the poster and follows the report link. In only a couple of minutes she finds Milena's qualifications and emails her to set up a recruiter call.

User Story 2: Dr G. evaluates research alignment and interest

As a Principal Investigator, I want to read the details and reports of a candidate's past projects, so that I can judge whether their skills fit my lab's work.

Dr G. is interested in cloud detection for climate forecasting. On the Projects page, he finds "Machine Learning for Cloud Detection in Satellite Imagery", reads the bullets on the models and features Milena worked on, and notes the tools and datasets. He opens the PDF report to read the methods and results. The three column layout of the Project page lets him compare dates, descriptions, and figures of different projects quickly, and he decides to email Milena.

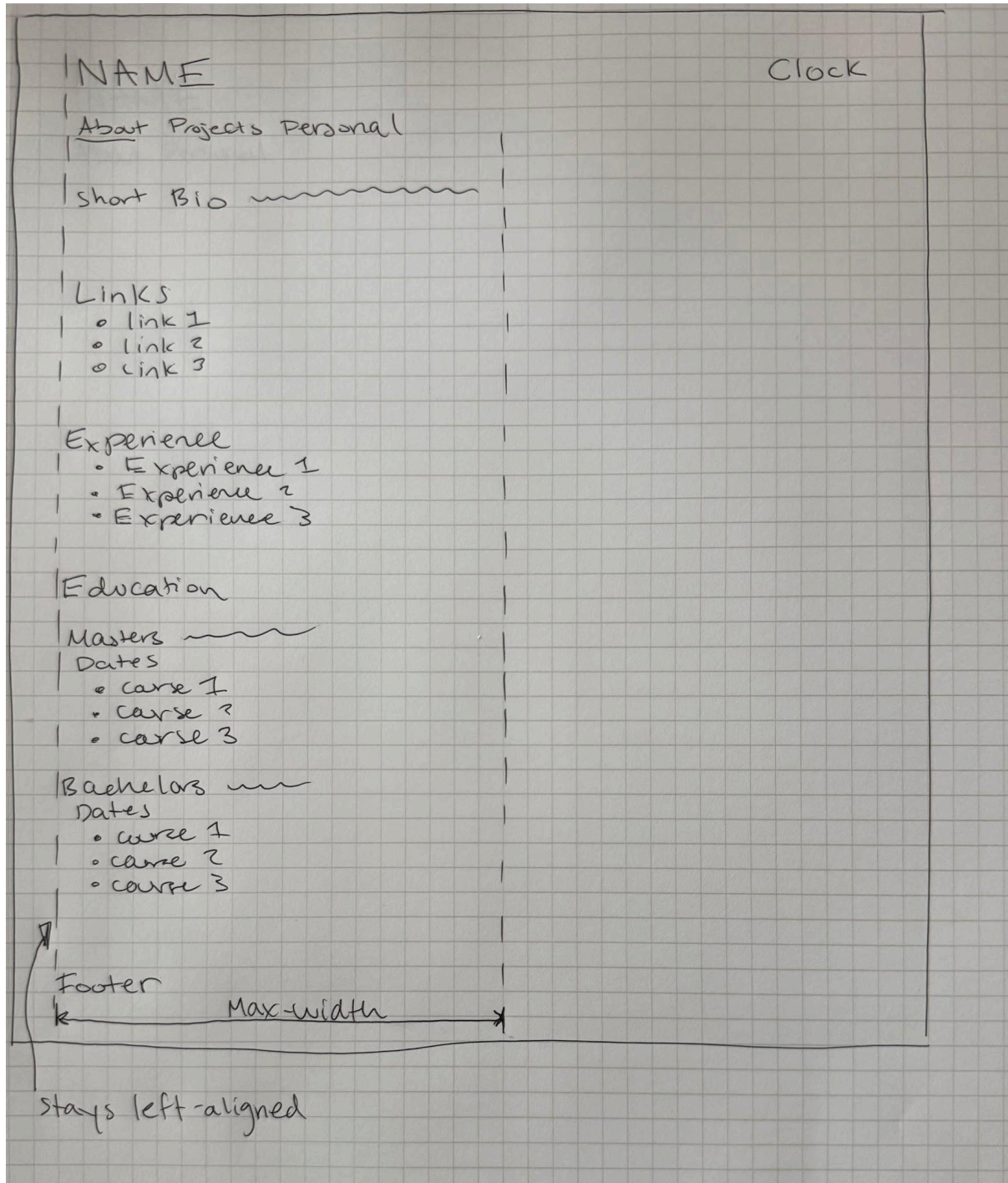
User Story 3: Ed discovers a shared interest

As a classmate, I want to learn more about my peer's interests outside of school, so that I can find common ground before reaching out about a group project.

Ed visits Milena's website after seeing her submission in the Project submissions for the CS5610 Web Development course. On the Personal page, he sees a forest photo zoom slightly when he hovers over it, and he gathers the hint that it is clickable. He clicks it and the caption appears: a solo hike through the woods of Mons Klint. Ed loves hiking too. He heads back to the About page and uses the links to reach out on LinkedIn about partnering on the next project.

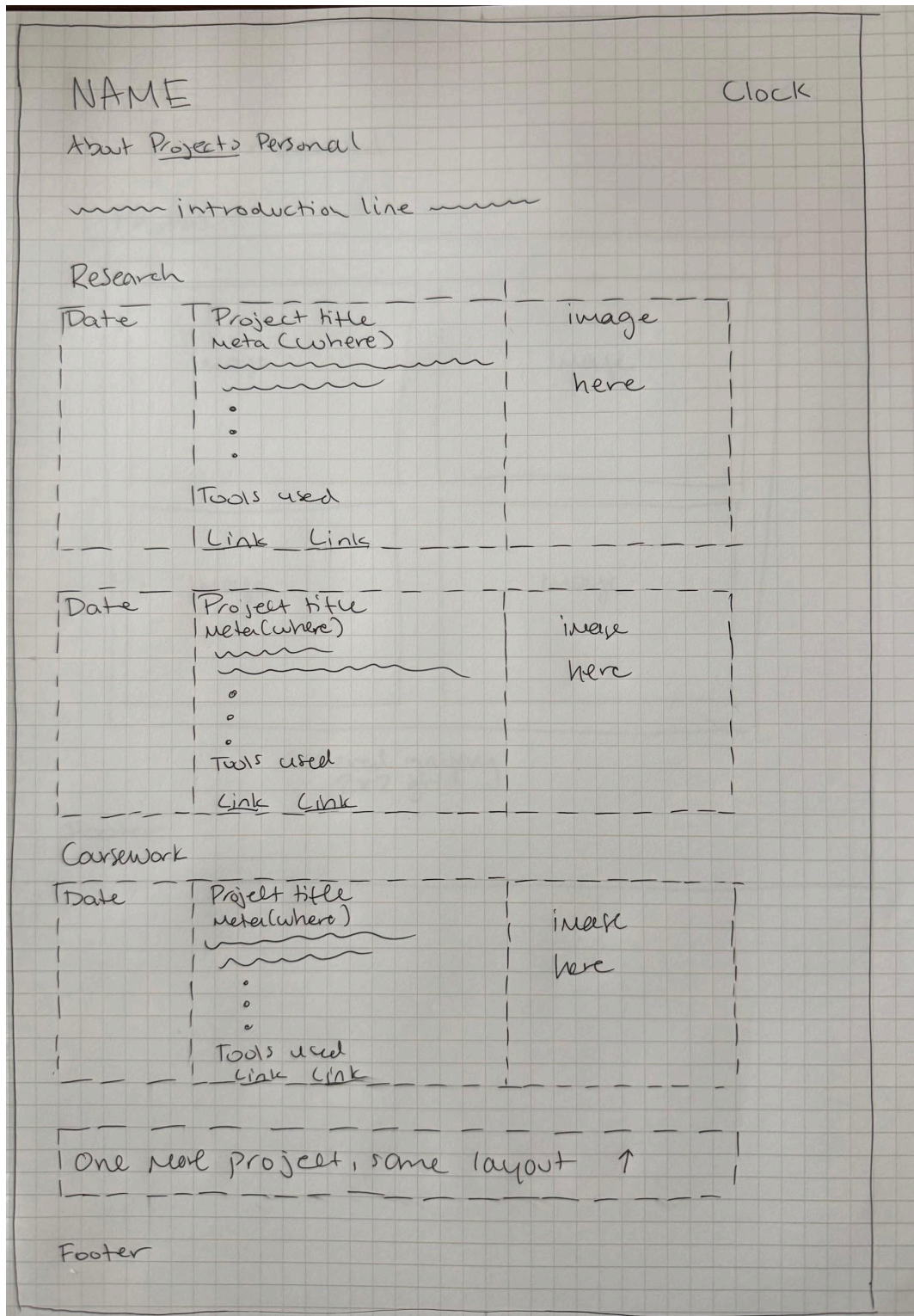
Wireframes

Figure 1: About page (index.html)



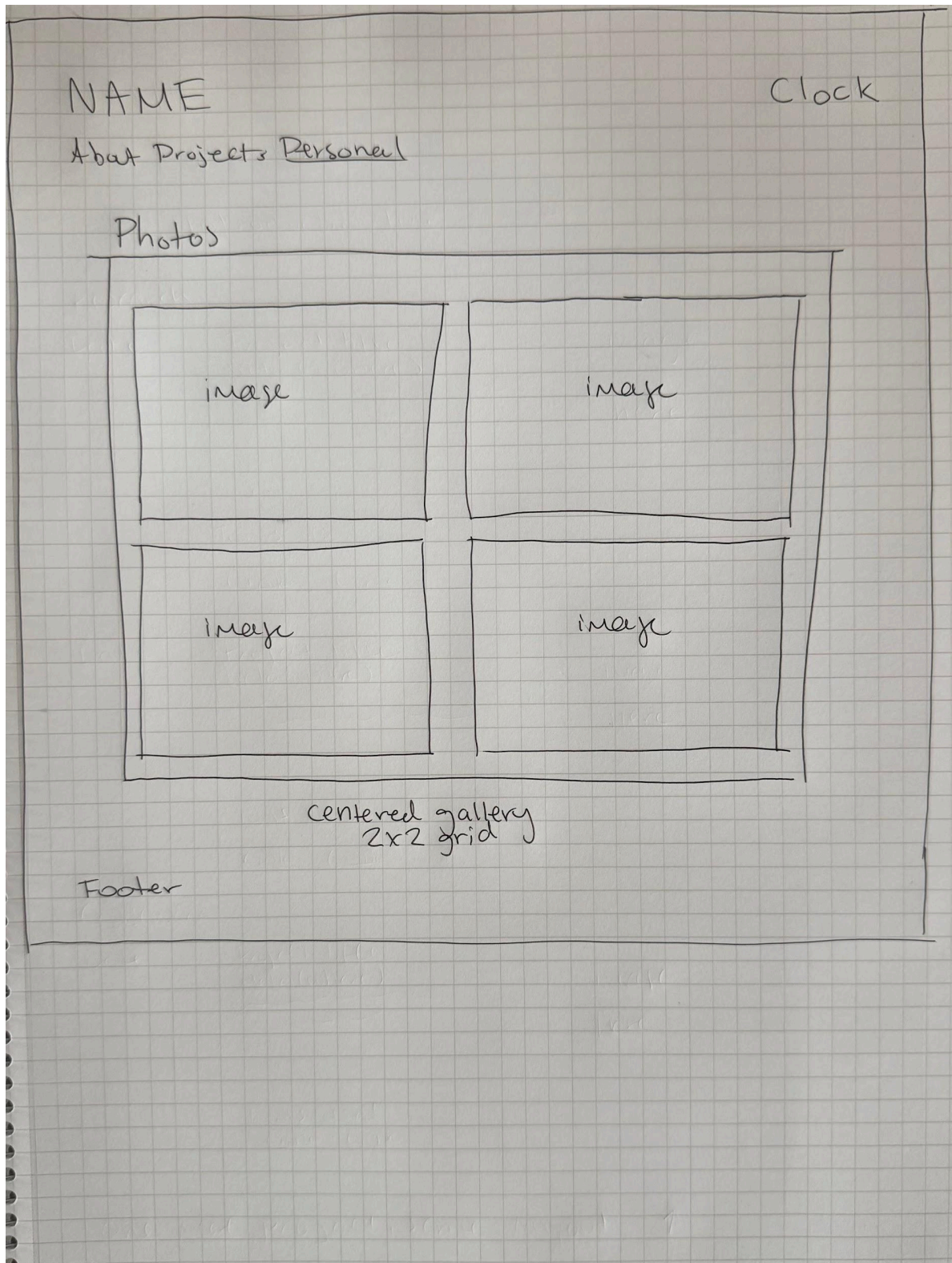
The About page uses a book-inspired layout. There is a single left-aligned column with a max width so there is empty space on the right. The most important information stays short and easy to read.

Figure 2: Projects page (projects.html)



The project page uses a three-column layout grid for each project. The date stays on the left column, the project's title, description, contribution, tools, and links stay in the middle column, and the project figure stays in the right column. The page is wider to fit three columns. There are two sections of projects: research and coursework.

Figure 3: Personal page (personal.html)



The Personal page breaks from the book layout with a centered 2×2 photo gallery. Hovering over a photo zooms it slightly to show it is clickable. Clicking a photo reveals a caption over it with the date and my notes on the setting, and clicking again hides it. This is the site's creative addition.